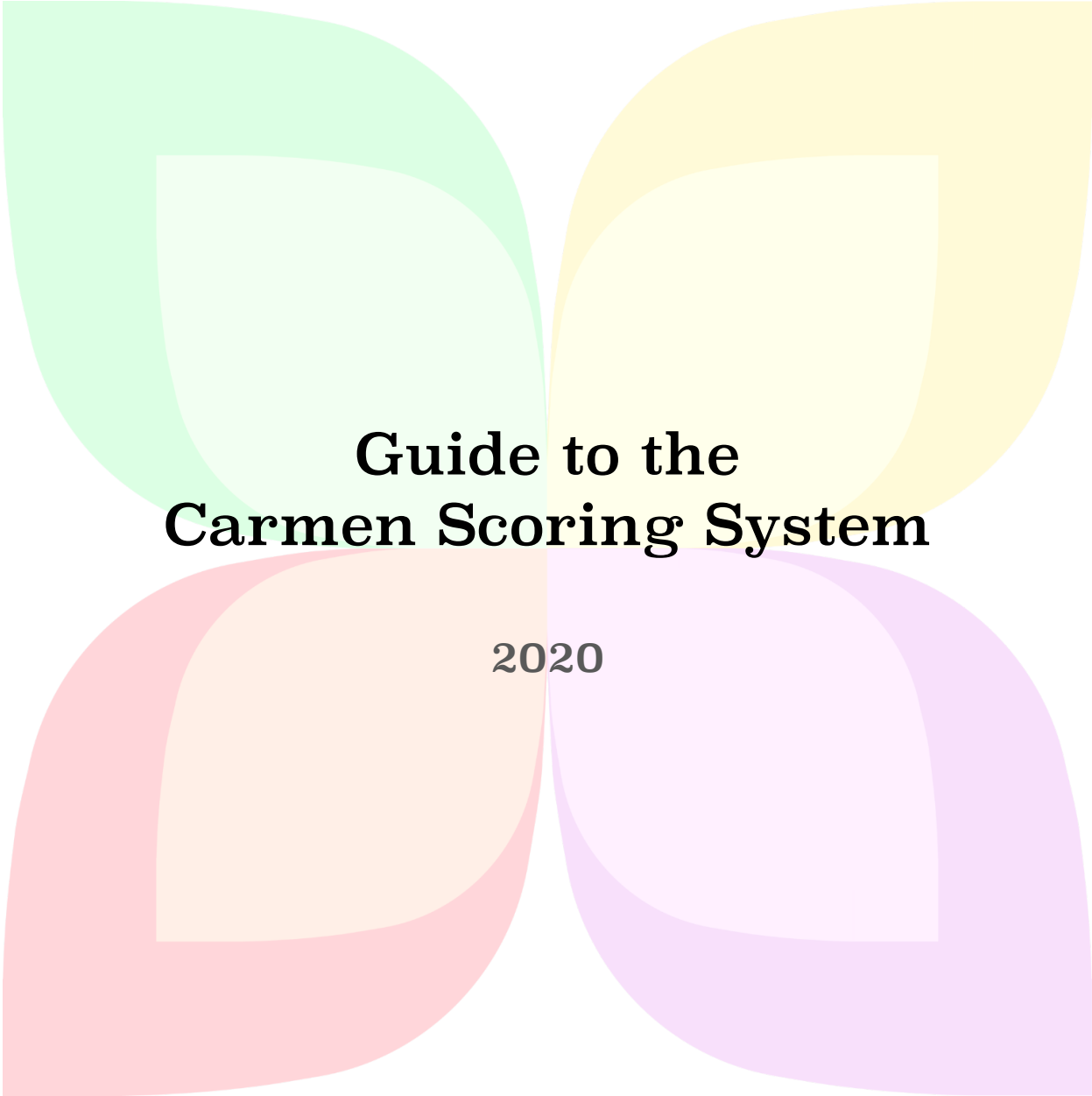




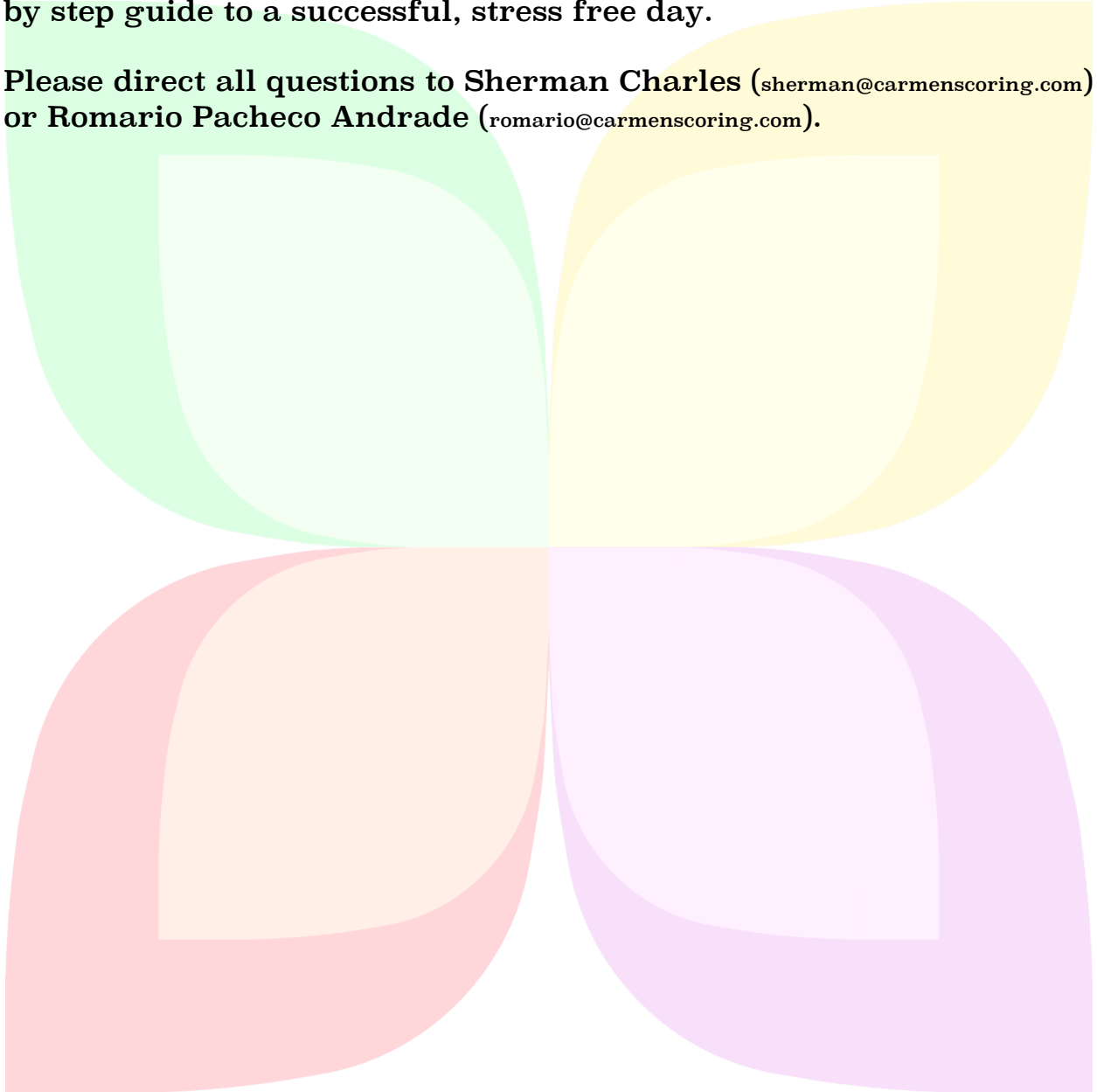
Guide to the Carmen Scoring System

2020

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This document functions as a walkthrough for administering the Carmen Scoring System at adjudicated showchoir events. It is a step by step guide to a successful, stress free day.

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Setting up the Event

Please take the following steps to set up your event in the Carmen System.

Everything you type in here is how it will appear throughout the system, including awards pages, judge's pages, results pages, and public pages. *So, make it look nice!*

Before you start, make sure you have the following information:

- Which scoresheet you would like to use.
 - For a scoresheets that are already in the Carmen System, please contact us at info@carmenscoring.com. You may also choose to design and submit your own scoresheet. Once it is reviewed and accepted by the Carmen Team, it will be added to our system.
- Which method you would like to use to calculate results.
 - For a description of each method that is available, go to carmenscoring.com/methods. We highly recommend the Condorcet method, but the choice is yours.
- Schedule of performances and Divisions
- Directors' emails and cell phone numbers
- Awards
- Judges and their emails

Creating the Competition

After you login as an Organization Administrator, the first page you see will be a list of all competitions for that organization. If this is your first time, it will be blank.

1. To begin, click **add competition**
2. In the competition name field, please enter the name of your institution followed by the name of your competition and ending with the year (e.g. Carmen Showcase 2019).

3. In the event that directors did not receive their results via email nor text message, the Carmen System creates a link and access code that can be given to the directors for access. This link should only be used in case of emergency. The following two fields help you customize the link and access code.
 - a. The URL slug should be something short and easy to type. It will facilitate getting results to directors, so the easier the better. We recommend the name of the organization and the year (e.g. carmen2019).
 - b. For the Results Access Code, we also recommend something short and easy to type to facilitate getting results to directors. I suggest the competition name and the year (e.g. showcase2019).
4. The next two fields are the start and end dates for your competition. This is so the Carmen System can keep all competitions organized in chronological order. If your competition starts and ends on the same day, enter the same date for both fields. Please follow the displayed date format.
5. Depending on your region, the place awards may be called something different. The Carmen System allows you to choose from two commonly used titles. Select whether you would like your overall awards listed as 1st, 2nd, 3rd, etc. or Grand Champion, 1RU, 2RU, etc.
6. We also like to keep track of where all of our competitions occur. Please enter the location of your event.
7. When you have finished, please save. Keep in mind that if you need to change any of this information, you have the ability to edit these settings at any time.

When you have saved your newly created competition, the next page you will be taken to is Competition Details Page. This is the main operating page, or dashboard, for your competition where you will find links to everything you will need.

Creating the Divisions

Once you have your competition entered into the Carmen System, you can create your Showchoir Divisions. Divisions allow the organizer to separate the different participating groups into smaller subsets for the purpose of awarding Division specific awards. Divisions have names like Large High School Mixed, Single Gender, Middle School, etc. Be specific to help everyone out.

1. Under **Manage Divisions**, click **Create your first division**
2. Enter the Division name (e.g. High School Large Mixed, Single Gender, or Middle School Mixed).
3. For weighting, if your competition is going to use the Carmen Showchoir Scoresheets, choose either weighted or not weighted. This determines how much the Captions Music and Show are worth; Weighted is 60/40 and not weighted is 50/50. If you are not using Carmen Showchoir Scoresheets, select 50/50.
4. Scoring Method determines how awards are calculated. We highly recommend the Condorcet method, but the choice is yours.
 - a. If you are not sure which you should use, please contact us at info@carmenscoring.com.
5. Choose the scoresheet that your competition has decided to use. You may choose any of the scoresheets listed, or you can choose to create your own custom scoresheet. To do so, contact us at info@carmenscoring.com.

CAUTION If multiple Divisions qualify for a Finals Round at your competition, all of the preliminary Divisions must use the same scoresheet.

6. Rating Systems (awarding Gold, Silver, Bronze type awards) are a valuable way to award all choirs for their participation

at your competition and help them keep track of personal bests as they compete throughout the season. For example, at the beginning of the season a choir might receive Bronze or Silver Ratings, but by the end of the season, they could receive Gold Ratings. Regardless of their place among the competing choirs, they have achieved a Gold Rating!

- a. If you do not use a Rating System you can ignore the following steps and jump to the last step of this section.
 - b. If you do use a Rating System, specify the name of each award and the minimum percentage of the score that qualifies for each of them.
7. When you have finished, and you want to continue with the next division, click **Save & Create Another**, otherwise, click **Save Division**
8. Repeat these steps for all Divisions at your competition. If you need to edit any previously created Divisions, click on the name of the Division and then **edit division**
9. Once you have finished creating all Divisions, click on the name of your Competition in purple letters near the top of the screen to go back to the Competition Details Page.

Adding Choirs, Judges, Rounds and Awards

Once you have finished creating, click **manage your divisions**. Here you will find a table of the divisions and various aspects that you have set for each of them. The Carmen Scoring System is so flexible that it allows each and every Division to have its own specific set up.

1. Click **Set up** on the first Division of your competition. Here you will enter in all of the choirs, judges, and rounds for this Division.

2. To add a Choir to the Division, click **Add a choir** at the bottom of the Choirs column on the left side of the page and a pop-up box will appear.

- a. The Carmen System database already has many choirs from all over the US and Canada. You can search for a choir by typing their name in the drop-down menu field (e.g. Carmen High School “Flowers”).

- b. If you cannot find the choir you are looking for, click **Create a new choir** under the drop down menu field.

- i. Enter the name of the Choir (e.g. Flowers)

- ii. Enter the director's information. It is crucial that the director's email and mobile number are correct since this is how they will receive results and feedback.

- iii. Find the school in our database if it is already there, or select **Create a new school** if it is not.

1. Enter the school name (e.g. Carmen High School).

2. Please specify if it's a High School, Middle School, Jr High, Intermediate, Performing Arts Center, etc.

3. Enter the City and State

- c. Click **Save Choir**

- d. Repeat until all choirs have been entered for that Division

3. To add a Judge to the Division, click **Add a judge** at the bottom of the Judges column in the middle of the page and a pop-up box will appear.

- a. Similar to the Choirs, most Judges have already been entered into the system. You can search for them by entering their name in the drop-down menu field.

- b. If they are not, you will need to add them.

- i. To add a Judge to the Carmen System, select

- Create a new judge**

- ii. Enter their information

- c. The last step assigns them the captions they will be evaluating for that Division. At some competitions, there are Vocal Judges, Choreography Judges, Band Judges, etc., and at others, each Judge evaluates the whole scoresheet. To assign the captions for the current judge, check each of the boxes next to the caption title.
- d. When you have finished, click **Save Judge**
- e. Repeat for all judges

SHORT CUT If you have already entered your judges in another division, you can import them with three easy clicks.

- f. Click the Judges tab at the top of the panel
 - g. Click **import judges**
 - h. Select which group of judges you would like to import
 - i. Click **Import Judges**
4. Scores and calculations are held inside what we call Rounds. Each division needs to have a Round in order for judges to score the participating choirs.
 - a. Click **Add a round...**
 - b. Type in a name of the Round (e.g Scores, Prelims Scores, Finals Scores)
 - c. Make sure the sequence is 1
 - d. If this is a Prelims Round, select **All choirs in this division**
 - e. If this is a Finals Round, select **Some choirs from other rounds**
 - f. Type in the number of finalists that can qualify for finals
 - g. Select which Divisions qualify for finals
 - h. Save
 5. Now we need to set up Awards
 - a. Click the Awards tab
 - b. If you are giving out overall place awards, select **edit award settings**

- c. Specify how many places you will award for overall place and caption awards that are determined by scores (e.g. Best Music, Best Show, Best Vocals, Best Visuals, etc.)
 - d. You may add a description if you would like or you can leave it blank.
 - e. If you have awards sponsors, you can list them here.
 - f. Save
 - g. If you have any extra awards that are not determined by scores for this division alone, you may also add them to this division.
 - h. If it's your first time using Carmen, you will select **create new award**
 - i. Add the name, description if you would like, and sponsor if you would like
 - ii. Save
 - iii. Repeat for each new award
 - i. If you have already entered in these awards in years past or in other divisions, select **manage division awards**
 - i. Check any awards you would like to use in this Division
 - ii. Save
 - j. If you need to enter a new award, select **create new award** and enter the relevant information
 - k. Repeat these steps for all Divisions
6. Setting up a Solo Division
- a. Carmen is also equipped to handle solo competitions. It works similarly to the showchoir divisions
 - b. From the Competition Details page, select **create a solo division** under the header **Manage Solo Divisions**
 - c. Type in the name of the Division (e.g. Middle School Solo Competition, High School Solo Competition)
 - d. Choose the solo scoresheet you would like to use
 - e. Enter in the total number of participants
 - f. Enter up to two Judge(s)
 - g. Save
 - h. Select **manage performers**

- i. Each line represents a participant. Please specify the choir they come from in the first column. No need to specify gender or name at this point. If a single choir has more than one participant in the Solo Division, please select the same choir in the same number of rows as there are participants from that choir.
- j. Save
- k. Select [back to solo division](#)

Before the Event

A few hours ahead of the first scheduled performance, review everything you have set up and cross check all information to make sure what you have entered into the system is accurate. Make any modifications necessary.

1. This includes:
 - a. Division Settings
 - b. Setting Choir performance order in each Round
 - c. Judges and their assigned Captions
 - d. All relevant Awards

Before the training meeting, make sure you reset every judge's password to the same easy-to-remember password. To do this, follow these steps:

1. From the Competition Details page, click the first Division, then the Judges tab
2. Under each of the judge's names, click [reset password](#)
3. Choose something easy to remember, like the acronym for your competition plus the year (e.g. Carmen's Showchoir Competition 2018 = csc2018)

4. Repeat for each of the judges in that Division
5. Once you have reset their password in one Division, it has been reset for all Divisions they are judging. So, if the judges are the same throughout the whole competition, you are done. If you have different judges throughout your event (i.e. added judges for Finals or an entirely different set all together), you will need to find them in a division they have been assigned and reset their password there.
6. Make sure they each have either a laptop or a tablet that has internet connection. If you are using our built-in recorder, make sure they have a microphone.

Training your Judges

Ask your judges to follow along with these steps:

1. Go to carmenscoring.com
2. Click **login** at the top
3. Their usernames are their first and last name, all lowercase, no space (e.g. shermancharles)
4. Their passwords are what you reset them as
5. The first page they see will list all competitions they have judged, are judging, and will judge. Have them select your competition.
6. Ask them to select the first Division they will be evaluating
7. This will take them to the Summary View of their scores. Explain the layout to them as such:

- a. In the left column are the choirs' names
 - b. In the middle will be your raw score totals (and weighted if you are using weighted)
 - c. In the right column you will find buttons that say **Start Recording**. If the judges are using their mobile devices or a second internet device for their recordings, this is the page where they will make their voice comments. They simply click the button for the relevant choir, and a warning message may appear asking for permission to use the microphone. They should affirm.
 - d. If they are not using a second device for recordings, continue to the next step.
8. To enter and modify scores, have them click on the **go to spreadsheet view** button on the top right-hand side.
- a. Explain that the categories are listed on the side and the choirs are listed along the top. To enter a score, click on the cell corresponding to the desired choir and category. A number keyboard will appear at the bottom of the screen from which they assign a score. A short description is also provided for each category. Totals and ranks will automatically update. A check mark will appear when the score has been saved appropriately. An exclamation point means do it again.
 - b. To enter scores in a rapid fashion once they are accustomed with the scoresheet categories, they can click the choir's name at the top. This will display the keyboard for all categories. At the top of the box, they can toggle between captions.
 - c. Ask them to scroll to the bottom of the screen. They will find a row labeled 'Comments'. If they click on a corresponding cell, a text box will appear where they can leave typed comments if they desire.
 - d. The next row they will find another **Start Recording** button. If they are using a USB microphone to make their comments, this is where they will make their voice comments. Again, when they push the button, it might ask

for permission to use the microphone, and they should affirm. When they are finished, they should click **Stop Recording**. A new media player will pop up under the button and immediately save the recorded file. If the judge would like to play back their file, they may. They can make as many recordings as they wish.

- e. If they get a warning, follow the prompt or ask your assistant for help.
 - f. They should refresh often and double check that scores have indeed saved. Make it a routine to refresh after you have entered scores for each group
9. At this point, you can tell them they are already at the top of the learning curve and that's all they need to know to operate the system.

During the Event

Before your first group goes on, make sure you have activated the first Division of the day. Otherwise, the judges will not be able to enter scores. To do this, take the following steps:

1. Click on the Division
2. Click on the Rounds tab
3. Click **activate scoring**

As the judges are entering in scores, monitor that they are on the right choir, haven't missed any categories, and that there is no other 'funny business' going on.

It is also a good idea to keep an eye out for ties. If one judge has two or more choirs tied for a place, ask them kindly to break the tie.

Ties between judges will be dealt with later. To monitor scores, take the following steps:

1. Open the Division
2. Click on the Rounds tab
3. Click on the Round name in purple letters (e.g. Prelims, Finals, Friday, Saturday, etc.)
4. Click on the current choir's name
5. Check that all cells have a score greater than 0.0
6. If you find an empty cell or a tie within a judge, kindly ask the relevant judge(s) to modify their scores appropriately.

Every once in a while, check on your judges in person to see if everything is ok. They might be waiting for you to come by to ask you a question.

Preparing for Awards

Verify with the judges that they are finished entering scores, but do not dismiss them yet. Once they all verbally confirm they have finished, complete scoring for each round that will be announced in the awards ceremony, and still do not dismiss the judges. To complete scoring, take the following steps:

1. Open the relevant Division, click on the Rounds tab, select **complete scoring**. This locks the judges out of entering or modifying scores and calculates the final standings.
2. Repeat for each division that will be awarded in the ceremony immediately following.

If you need to apply a penalty, now is the time to do it. Judges should not be able to change their scores after a penalty is applied. To do this, take the following steps:

1. Open the Division and click the Penalties Tab

2. Select **create a new penalty**

3. Give it a logical name and a description if you want

4. Specify how much the penalty is worth numerically

5. If you are using the Raw Score method, select no for apply per judge.

6. If you are using any other method, select yes for apply per judge.

7. Save

8. Select **assign penalty**

9. Select the Round name

10. Select the choir that is to be penalized

11. Check the penalties to apply

12. Save

13. Repeat for each penalty

At this time, the judges can decide on any remaining awards to give out (e.g. Best Soloist, Best Costumes, etc.) and you should check for any ties that might be in the scores. To do this, take the following steps:

1. Open the Division
2. Click on the Rounds tab
3. Click on the Round name in purple letters (e.g. Prelims, Finals, Friday, Saturday, etc.)
4. All ties will have a purple indicator.

If you find any ties in the overall results, follow your competition's rules for how to break a tie. Common tie breakers include using overall Weighted/Raw score, Vocal score, or unanimous decision from the judges. In general, if the tie does not affect actual awards or qualification into finals, you do not need to break it.

To manually override the system to break a tie, take the following steps:

1. Open the relevant Division, click on the Final Standings tab
2. Locate the tie that needs to be broken and select **modify standings** in the appropriate caption heading.
3. Adjust the rankings as necessary.
4. Save

Throughout the day, depending on what kinds of awards your competition is giving out, you could receive results for some caption awards (e.g. Most Spirited, Best Set, etc.). You can enter these in as soon as you get them. You do not have to wait until the divisions are over to enter these awards. To do this, take the following steps:

1. Go to the relevant Division and click on the Awards Tab
2. Click **assign awards**

3. You can either type in the recipient manually, select a choir from the drop-down menu, or a combination of both. Make sure you save.

Once you are satisfied with the status of the results and all other awards are entered in, you are ready for the Awards Ceremony.

Awards Ceremony

From the Competition Details page, scroll to the very bottom and select Announcer View for the appropriate Awards Ceremony. Make sure everything is appearing as it should. This is the last check point for accuracy before awards are announced.

If everything is correct, take the list to the Awards Announcer, preferably on a tablet but you can also print this page. Explain to them that they can keep track of which awards they have already announced by clicking them to cross them out on the list. This is a toggle so they can turn it off and on.

Follow along with as the Announcer is giving out awards. Make sure you they stay on track and announce the right winners. Stop them if they do something wrong and fix the situation as professionally as possible.

Once the Awards Ceremony is complete, return back to your computer to send out results to directors.

CAUTION This sends the results to all directors via email and text message immediately and cannot be undone. Make sure it is time to send results before proceeding.

To send results to directors, follow these steps:

1. Open the relevant Division(s)

2. Click the Overview tab

3. Click **complete scoring**

4. Click **finalize/publish**

Troubleshooting getting results to directors

All directors should receive emails and/or text messages with links to the results and comments.

IMPORTANT Directors will only receive typed comments if the judges wrote them.

If they are having trouble getting their results, take the following steps:

1. Ask them to check their junk mail folder
2. Ask them to check their text messages

If they confirm that they did not receive results, you have three options:

1. Provide them with the results link that is displayed on the Overview tab of the relevant Division. To get this, take the following steps:
 - a. Open the relevant Division
 - b. The URL link is in the blue box written in purple font.
 - c. Copy and paste this into an email and send it to them
2. Ask them to go to carmenscoring.com, click results, click the year, click the name of the competition, and enter their email address that we have on file in the blue box

3. Provide them with the URL link and access code on the Competition Details page

When in doubt, ask them to contact either Sherman Charles (sherman@carmenscoring.com, 937.243.8653) or Romario Pacheco (romario@carmenscoring.com, 937.537.2198)

